Siya, Strand 09 -- The Glass Ledger and the Ladder

Stamp: `STAMP` -- taken from the one clock at seating, never typed by counsel
Language: EN
Style: New Gauge, Door setting -- Civic and TAME carried through, in plain words for Sara and Keaton
Voice: Kyri (Grain Kyri 6) -- Claude Fable 5, counsel to Siya Fund
Shape: single-stranded -- about one thing; the composed reading lives in `Siya, composed`
Status: Living -- a foundation. Nothing here is investment, legal, or tax advice; nothing seats; every money move waits behind the gates in Strand 10 and the licensed team
Field only: names the family, a friend, and the family's companies; the seed projector withholds it
The one thing this strand holds: the fund's deals can give the family's software its first users and its shape, and only strangers can give it proof.

What the software is

The family builds software in the open, so that whoever runs it owns it. Grain is the language and toolchain underneath. Linengrow is the giving rail, where a gift writes a receipt anyone can verify. Dimeroll keeps one set of books per company, never braided with another's. Mantra remembers by content rather than by name, so a record cannot be quietly changed. Each is about one thing, and they sit side by side.

The sleeve memos already named the first product without calling it one. In a real-estate deal, the fund's books, the property's books, and the operator's books each stay whole in Dimeroll, and the receipts from the field and the mill fold beside them. Any co-investor with the log can read all of it. The fiber sleeve memo called that a due-diligence surface no sponsor's quarterly letter can match, and it is the reason another investor would sit in a deal beside Siya rather than beside a stranger. Call it the glass ledger.

Simple, lovable, complete

The family ships by three words. Simple means one thing, narrow on purpose. Lovable means someone would miss it if it were gone. Complete means the loop closes, so the narrow thing does everything it claims. The glass ledger fits all three on its first deployment: one deal, one set of co-investors, one fold that closes.

What a deal can give, and what it cannot

Keaton's thesis is that the fund's properties, companies, and ventures should be chosen so that they help the family's software find its market, among ecological and materials businesses and among advisers like the investing community the family joined. Read the way this family reads a policy, that idea has two halves that want separate sentences.

A portfolio business can give the software its first users, its requirements, its testimony, and its shape. That is a design partner, and design partners are exactly what the three words above need. What a portfolio business cannot give is proof. Revenue that arrives from a company the family funds is money the family paid itself, one step removed. A seed investor reads it as related-party revenue and discounts it toward zero. An auditor flags it. And the family's own return would be counted twice on the same dollars. The reward, read plainly, would measure Siya's willingness to fund rather than a market's willingness to pay, and those two stay separate by design.

The ladder

So the path is a ladder, with the family's own rungs at the bottom and the proof at the top.

The first rung is the family's own deal: its syndicate, its property, its operator, running the ledger on real books. That proves the loop closes. The second rung is the co-investors in that deal, strangers with money in it, who want the surface. That proves someone prefers this deal because of it. The third rung is a sponsor the family has never met, paying for the ledger at an arm's-length price. That proves a market wants it. The fourth rung is ten paying customers with no tie to the family's money, still paying a year later. That is product-market fit, and it is what a seed investor buys.

Three rules hold the ladder up. Every rung pays a real price, written down, with the first rung at a named design-partner rate rather than free. Every portfolio business wears its three hats separately, investor, customer, and spokesperson, so a kind word on a slide names its own conflict. And the software company's own books show the affiliated rungs in their own color, which Dimeroll already does.

The strongest idea in Keaton's thesis is the adviser community as a customer, and it belongs on the third rung. A sponsor or an investing community that pays for investor reporting with verifiable receipts is a customer with no tie to Siya's money. Vendors already sell investor portals to small sponsors. What the family's product carries that theirs lack is openness and verifiability, and that difference is proven on the day a community pays for it.

Two companies, two stories

DJINN's company sells forensic chain analysis to exchanges, compliance desks, and law firms, and none of those sit in Siya's sleeves. What the fund can offer him is a design partner for public-chain receipts on the giving rail, and the same rule holds: proof comes from the compliance desk that pays. Keaton's story stands on Grain and Linengrow as a product, with the works town as its first deployment. Each story is told without a conflict on the first slide because the ladder was papered from the first invoice.

The round after this one

Keaton named three firms as the kind of seed investor he and DJINN hope to reach after the family-and-friends round. Read by their own published numbers, the first is an AI-focused early-stage firm with a USD 230 million second fund closed in January 2025. The second is a broad earliest-stage firm with USD 500 million raised in 2022, a USD 1.75 million pre-seed check in February 2026, and a tilt toward crypto that fits DJINN's story. The third is a champion athlete's renamed firm whose new fund writes initial checks of USD 5 million to 10 million into tech and AI-enabled companies (Inc., August 2026), which is a later round rather than a first. None of the three publishes an ecological or materials thesis, so the story that reaches them is the software with the works town as its first deployment, rather than the works town with software attached.

What a seed investor buys is a product rather than a service, a team that can build it, and evidence that people the founders have never met will pay. Consulting is the door and the product is the house. A seed investor funds the house, and the door is how the family learns which house to build.

What stands, and what is proposed

What stands: the four tools, the glass ledger as the sleeve memos describe it, and the three firms' published numbers. What is proposed: the ladder, the design-partner rate, and the order of customers, which wait on securities counsel and Keaton's word.

What would show this wrong

Two design-partner deployments and zero arm's-length invoices at month eighteen. That would mean the shape is loved by the family and by nobody else yet, and the next move would be to find out why.

Written together by Keaton and Kyri.